

The AI Permit: Navigating Student-Centered Learning in a Generative Age

- **Course:** Student-Centered Learning 15 (Locally Developed Course - LDC1234)
- **Value:** 3 Credits
- **Objective:** Equip students to **ethically** and critically unlock Level 1 (Support) and Level 2 (Assisted) Assessment Permits.



Banning tools fails; developing adaptive, self-reliant learners succeeds



The Mandate: Student-centred learning involves becoming aware of one's own process of learning. It includes developing dispositions that support motivation, self-regulation, perseverance, adaptability, and resilience.

The Rationale: As the educational landscape shifts, students must use self-reflection and metacognition to build lifelong learning habits and adaptive capacity.



The instructional blueprint operationalizes three core learning outcomes



Developing Understanding

Identifying the specific best practices of a student-centered learner navigating an AI-integrated world.



Analyzing & Reflecting

Evaluating personal skillsets, identifying weaknesses, and recognizing the social-emotional barriers surrounding AI dependency.



Applying Strategies

Deploying targeted self-advocacy and reflective learning strategies to prepare for rigorous, verified assessments.

The three-tier framework clearly defines the boundaries of AI integration



Level 0 (No AI)

Complete foundational independence. AI tools are strictly prohibited to ensure baseline unassisted competency.

Level 1 (Support)

AI acts as a sounding board. Permitted for brainstorming, overcoming the blank page, and structural feedback.

Level 2 (Assisted)

Advanced integration. AI is used actively in the drafting, formatting, or heavy editing phases, requiring full disclosure and process tracking.

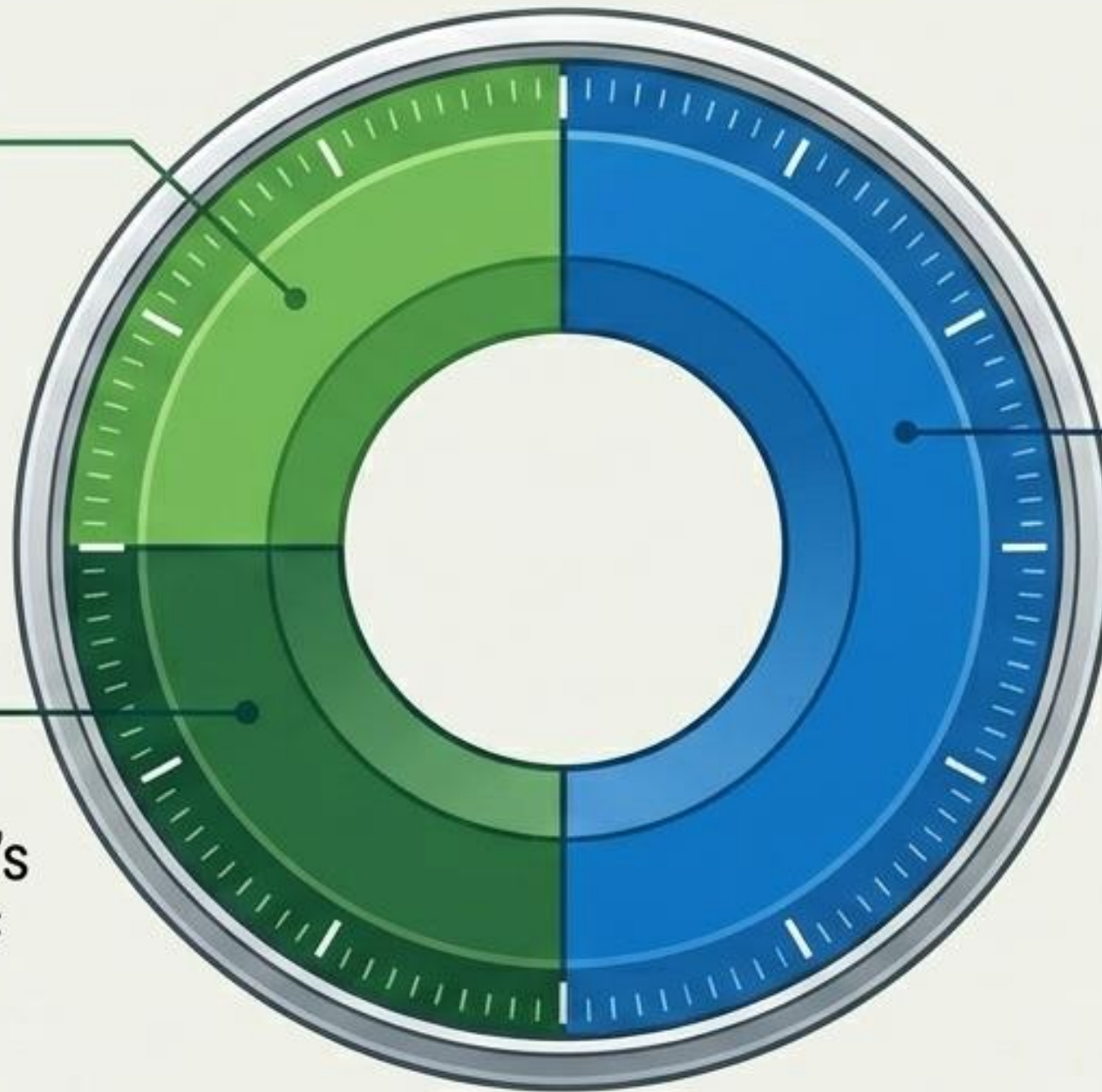
The 50/25/25 rule shifts grading weight from the final product to the learning process

25% - The Process

Evaluates perseverance, planning, and proper completion of the AI Use Log. Proves disclosure as self-advocacy.

25% - The Defence

Evaluates self-reflection, metacognition, and the student's ability to articulate why specific choices were made.



50% - Polished Product

The traditional output (essay, project, test).

Students must select the right vehicle for different phases of the learning journey



Google Gemini

- **Architecture:** Open Web LLM
- **Core Function:** Brainstorming, feedback, and predicting text.
- **Primary Danger:** Hallucinations (predicts plausible words, not verified facts).
- **Student Use Case:** Acting as a tutor to overcome social-emotional barriers like the blank page.



Google NotebookLM

- **Architecture:** Grounded AI Tool
- **Core Function:** Fact-checking, selecting main ideas, and test preparation.
- **Primary Danger:** Limited entirely to the base of materials the student uploads.
- **Student Use Case:** Generating targeted study guides and verifying claims against course materials.

Effective prompting forces the AI to act as a tutor rather than a ghostwriter.



Caution

The Ghostwriter Prompt (Outsourcing Thinking)

- **Input:** Fix my thesis statement for Social Studies 30-1 so it gets an A.
- **Result:** Bypasses information processing; undermines the student's ability to learn and adapt.



The Tutor Prompt (Socratic Prompting & Growth Mindset)

- **Input:** Review my thesis statement for Social Studies 30-1. Do not rewrite it for me, but ask me three questions that will help me reflect on potential next steps.
- **Result:** Fosters self-advocacy, forces the student to analyze feedback, and builds independent capacity.

Uncritical reliance on open web tools exposes students to the danger of hallucinations



The Mechanics of Hallucination

AI models like Gemini are designed to predict the most likely next word in a sequence. They do not possess a database of objective truth.

The Consequence of Copying

Uncritical copying demonstrates poor information processing. Presenting an AI hallucination as fact automatically invalidates the academic integrity of the submission.

The Solution

AI should be used strategically for planning and brainstorming, and its outputs must always be subjected to rigorous external verification.

Grounded tools require students to build an expert source board for verification



Building the Base:

Students manually upload valid class texts, articles, and their own notes into NotebookLM. The AI is restricted only to these documents.

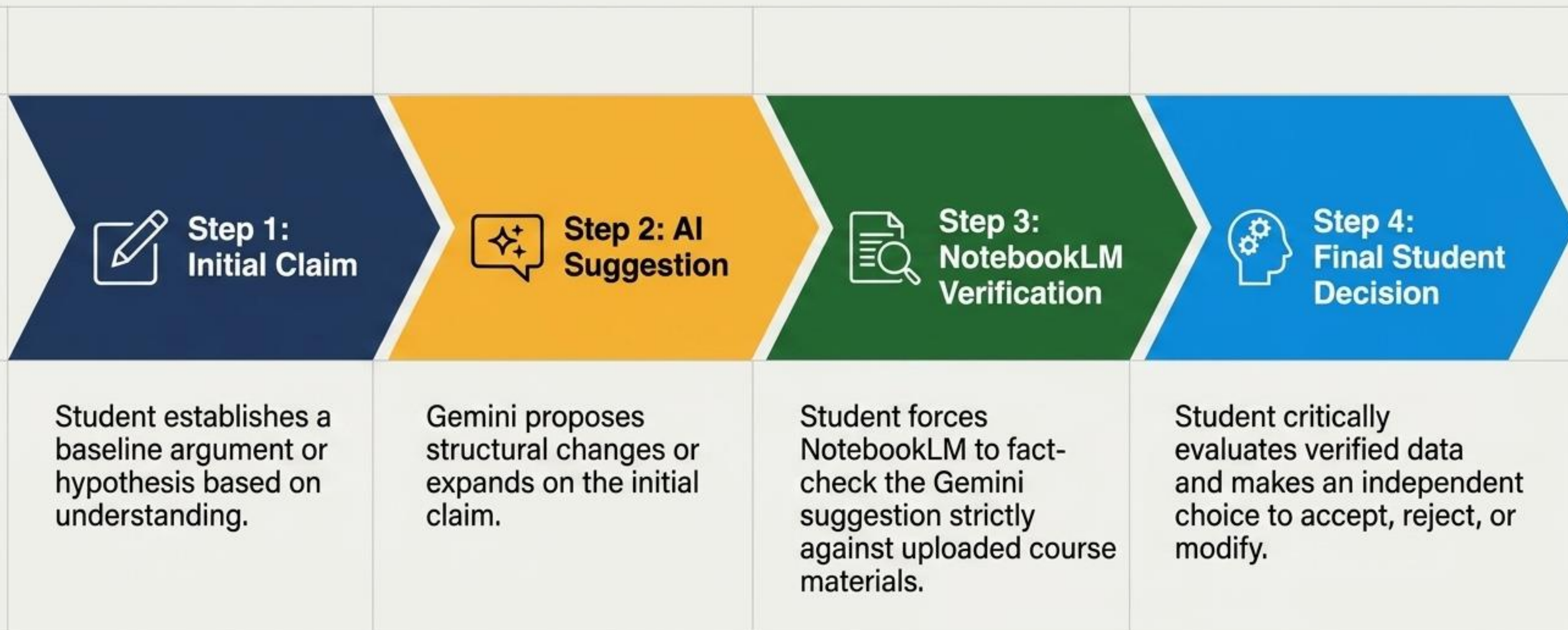
Monitoring Progress & Transfer:

By limiting the AI to course materials, students safely generate customized practice quizzes and study aides based entirely on their own curriculum.

Effective Test-Taking:

This process operationalizes SCL outcome 1.1.5, allowing students to self-monitor progress toward goals and build robust test-taking strategies.

The verification pipeline mandates continuous critical adaptability



The evidence burden makes the invisible process of learning visible and auditable

Creating the Prompt Trail



Students must export or screenshot their chat logs. This serves as raw data tracking the evolution of their thought process and information processing.

The 5-Minute Oral Defence



A highly structured teacher conference focused on metacognition.

Key Reflection Question: Why did you accept this specific structural change Gemini suggested? How does it show what you've learned?

The final assessment blueprint guarantees both theoretical knowledge and practical application

Part A: The Knowledge Check (80% Required)



A quiz assessing foundational awareness: definitions of Level 0/1/2 boundaries, the 50/25/25 grading weights, and the technical difference between generative and grounded AI tools.

Part B: The Practical Task (The Road Test)



Input: Receive weak thesis and primary source.



Self-Advocacy: Prompt Gemini for constructive thesis feedback.



Processing: Upload document to NotebookLM to extract verifying ideas.



Reflective Learning: Submit final thesis, prompt log, and written analysis of strengths/weaknesses.

Earning the permit unlocks verified integration and lifelong adaptive capacity



Growth Mindset Assessment: Missing components on the final task are not failed; they are re-evaluated and improved until mastery is proven.

The Ultimate Outcome: By completing SCL 15 and earning the AI Permit, students do not just gain access to tools—they demonstrate the transparent, critical thinking necessary to transfer learning across an ever-changing world.